MainWP Auto Updates Status: User Guide

Version 1.0.0 · October 24, 2026

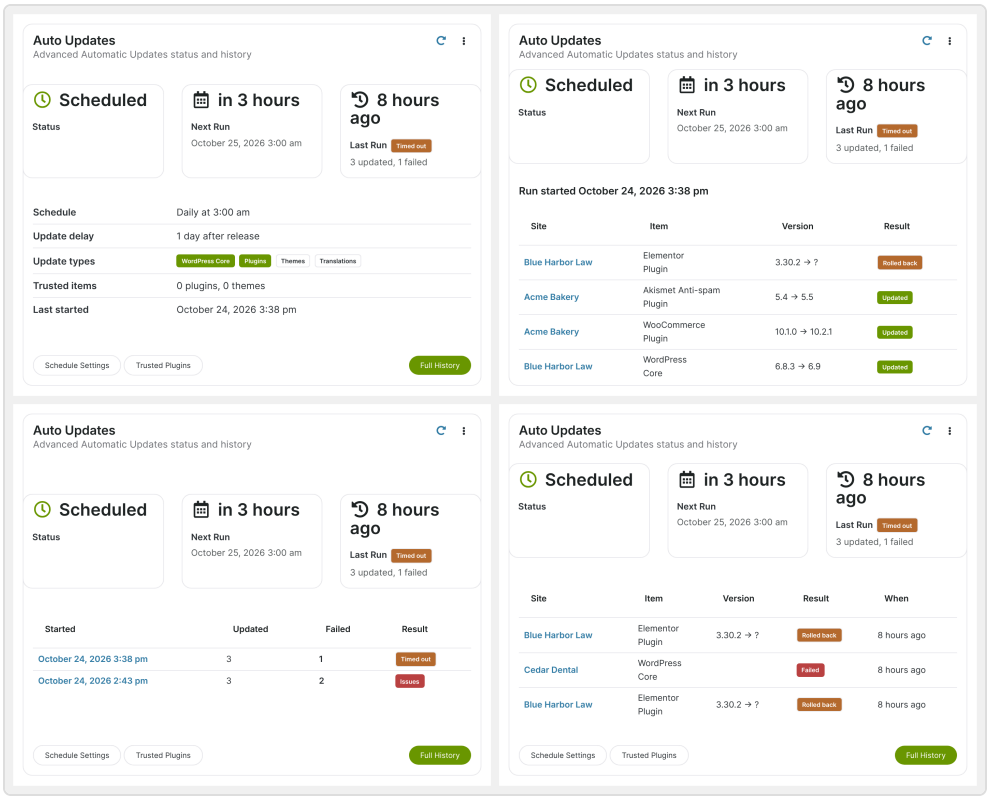
The Auto Updates widget shows, on your MainWP Operations page, whether MainWP's Advanced Automatic Updates are running and when they'll run next. It also shows what each run changed on your child sites, and which updates failed.

At a glance

The widget has four views, which you switch between with the ⋮ menu in its top-right corner:

- **Status:** is auto updating on, when is the next run, and how did the last run go.
- **Latest Run:** every update in the most recent run.
- **Run History:** the last 10 runs.
- **Recent Failures:** failed updates from all runs.

For the full history, click **Full History** at the bottom of the widget. The widget only shows and records information. It never runs, starts or changes updates itself; MainWP does that on its own schedule.



Top left to bottom right: Status, Latest Run, Run History, Recent Failures. Shown with sample data.

Status view

Three cards along the top answer "Is auto updating healthy?" and appear above every view.

Status card. One of four states:

State	What it means	What to do
Scheduled	Auto updates are on and waiting for the next run.	Nothing.
Running	A run is in progress. The card shows how many sites have been processed, for example "1 of 3 sites processed".	Nothing. The widget refreshes itself every 60 seconds until the run finishes.
Overdue	The scheduled time passed over an hour ago and no run started.	Check that cron is running on the Dashboard site (WP-Cron or a server cron job).
Disabled	Core, plugin and theme auto updates are all turned off in MainWP.	Turn on at least one type in **MainWP → Settings** if you want scheduled runs.

Next Run card. How long until the next run, with its exact date and time. It shows "Not scheduled" when auto updates are disabled.

Last Run card. When the last finished run started, a result label (see Result labels below), and how many items were updated and failed. A run that's still going is shown in the Status card instead.

Below the cards, the Status view lists:

Line	Shows
Progress bar	Only while a run is in progress: the percentage of sites processed and when the run started
Schedule	How often and when runs happen, for example "Daily at 3:00 am" or "Weekly on Monday at 2:00 am"
Update delay	How many days MainWP waits after an update is released before installing it
Update types	Green labels show which types are set to install trusted updates: WordPress Core, Plugins, Themes, Translations. Grey means off.
Trusted items	How many plugins and themes you've marked as trusted. Only trusted items are updated automatically.
Last started	When the most recent run started

All times use the timezone set in **WordPress → Settings → General**.

Latest Run, Run History and Recent Failures

Latest Run lists everything the most recent run tried to update. Each row shows:

- **Site:** click it to open that child site's MainWP overview.
- **Item:** the plugin, theme or translation name, or WordPress, with its type underneath.
- **Version:** old version → new version. A "?" means the child site didn't report that version, which is common when an update failed.
- **Result:** Updated, Failed or Rolled back. Hover over Failed or Rolled back to see the error the child site reported.

Failures are listed first. If the run found nothing to update, you'll see "Nothing was updated in this run."

Run History lists the last 10 runs, newest first. Each shows its start time, how many items were updated and failed, and a result label. Click a start time to open that run's full details. Older runs imported when you installed the plugin show "—" and "No details", because MainWP never kept their results.

Recent Failures lists the 15 most recent failed or rolled-back updates from all runs, with how long ago each happened. Use it to spot a plugin that keeps failing, or a site that keeps having problems.

The ↻ icon reloads the widget's data without reloading the page. The widget remembers which view you last chose, separately for each browser.

Full history page

Open it with **Full History** on the widget, or from **Add-ons → MainWP Auto Updates Status Extension**.

- **Auto Update Run History:** every recorded run, 25 to a page. Compared with the widget, each run also shows its **Duration** and its **Sites** count, meaning sites with changes out of sites included in the run (for example "2 of 3").
- **Recent Failures:** the last 50 failed or rolled-back updates.
- **Settings:** how many days of history to keep (administrators only; see How history works).

Click a run's start time to open its **run details**. That page shows totals for Updated, Failed, Sites Changed and Duration, followed by the full list of updates in that run. Use **All runs** to go back.

Result labels

Label	Applies to	Meaning
Updated	An update	The child site installed the new version.

Label	Applies to	Meaning
Failed	An update	The update didn't install. Hover over the label to see the error.
Rolled back	An update	The update was attempted, ran into a problem, and the child site went back to the previous version. Hover over the label to see why.
Success	A run	Every update in the run succeeded.
Issues	A run	At least one update failed or was rolled back.
Nothing to update	A run	The run finished, but no trusted item had an update past the delay period.
Running	A run	Still in progress.
Timed out	A run	MainWP stopped the run after 4 hours. Updates recorded before the cut-off are still listed.
Stopped	A run	Auto updates were turned off while the run was in progress.
No details	A run	A run from before the plugin was installed. Only its start time is known.

Common tasks

Check last night's run

1. Open **MainWP → Operations** and look at the **Last Run** card.
2. A green **Success** label means you're done. If you see **Issues**, open **Latest Run** from the ⋮ menu.

Investigate a failed update

1. In **Latest Run** or **Recent Failures**, hover over the **Failed** or **Rolled back** label to read the error.
2. Click the site name to open its overview in MainWP, then update the item by hand or look into the cause.
3. If the same plugin fails on several sites, think about removing it from your trusted list until the problem is fixed.

Change when updates run

1. Click **Schedule Settings** at the bottom of the widget. This opens **MainWP → Settings**.
2. Change the frequency, day, time or update delay for automatic updates and save. The widget's **Next Run** and **Schedule** pick up the change straight away.

Choose which plugins and themes update automatically

Click **Trusted Plugins** at the bottom of the widget. This opens MainWP's Advanced Auto Updates page, where you mark plugins and themes as trusted. The Status view's **Trusted items** line shows the new counts.

Hide or move the widget

To show or hide it, use the cog icon (Page Settings) on the Operations page and toggle **Auto Updates Status**. To move it, drag the widget by its title.

How history works

- **Where the data comes from.** MainWP keeps only the results of its latest run and clears them when the next run starts. This plugin copies each result as MainWP records it into its own history, so nothing is lost between runs. MainWP itself isn't changed.
- **History starts on activation.** Detailed history only exists from the day the plugin was activated. Runs that happen while the plugin is deactivated aren't recorded.
- **Retention.** History is kept for 90 days by default. Change this under **Settings** on the full history page; 0 keeps everything. Older runs are removed after each run finishes.
- **Who can see it.** Anyone with MainWP access to the global (Operations) dashboard can see the widget and the history page. Only WordPress administrators can change the retention setting.
- **Deleted sites.** If a child site is removed from MainWP, its past updates stay in the history and are labelled "Deleted site #ID".

For developers

The plugin has these hooks for customizing it from a small code snippet or another plugin:

Hook	Type	Use
`mainwp_aus_can_view`	Filter (bool)	Change who can see the widget and history page.
`mainwp_aus_refresh_interval`	Filter (int, seconds)	How often the widget refreshes during a run. The default is 60; 0 turns it off.
`mainwp_aus_widget_title`	Filter (string)	Change the widget title.
`mainwp_aus_run_finished`	Action (`$run_start`, `$status`)	Runs when a run has been recorded as finished, for example to send a Slack alert when the status is `timed_out`.

Example: refresh every 30 seconds during a run.

```
add_filter( 'mainwp_aus_refresh_interval', function () { return 30; } );
```